

EVIDENCE · CANVAS · SERIES

word-cloud

Spiral-packed word cloud — items sized by weight.

Weight is meaning in a word cloud.



SIZE = FREQUENCY

more

A
A
a

less

constellation scatters the words like stars.

substance **function**

component

gallery

form **manifest**

SIZE = FREQUENCY

more

A

A

a

less

dense packs the cloud tight.



SIZE = FREQUENCY

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less

spectrum colors the words along a scale.

function substance
universal
gallery
component
variant form manifest

SIZE = FREQUENCY

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less

focal crowns one word the center.



A word cloud visualization where the word "variants" is the largest and most central element, rendered in a large, blue, serif font. Surrounding it are several smaller words in different colors and fonts: "gallery" in orange, "declared" in grey, "docs" in grey, and "manifest" in green. The words are arranged in a way that "variants" dominates the center, while the other words are positioned around it, illustrating the concept of a focal word in a word cloud.

gallery declared

variants

docs manifest

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Stress test — 20 terms, raw frequency counts (512 → 5).



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Weight is meaning in a word cloud.

residency
onboarding pricing
time-to-value
integrations security support
roadmap contracts

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Weight is meaning in a word cloud.



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When NOT to reach for word-cloud.

Precise comparisons

If the audience needs to know that 'manifest' is 1.6× 'function', the spiral packing actively misleads. Use `progress` or a bar chart where the eye can compare lengths directly.

Two or three words

A three-word cloud is a list with extra steps. Use `stats` for a metric row or `big-number` for a single weighted headline.

Multi-word phrases

Each li should be a single token. Multi-word phrases blow out the layout and crowd the spiral; if your data is phrases, normalise to keywords first or use `quote` for verbatim text.

RELATED COMPONENTS

See also.

`progress` — the weights need precise visual comparison

`stats` — the headline metrics are independent numbers, not a corpus

`piechart` — the items are parts of a whole, not free-form themes

`quote` — the verbatim language matters more than the frequency

`list` — single-line takeaways — the `takeaway` variant